Introduction to HTML

A brief beginner-friendly guide to the language of the Web

1. What is HTML?

HTML (HyperText Markup Language) is the standard markup language used to structure content on web pages. It tells a browser what different pieces of content are, such as headings, paragraphs, links, images, lists, forms, and tables.

HTML is not a programming language. It is a **markup language** because it uses elements and tags to describe the structure and meaning of content.

2. Basic HTML Document Structure

A typical HTML document contains a document type declaration, an **<html>** element, a **<head>** section for metadata, and a **<body>** section containing visible page content.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
  <head>
    <title>My Web Page</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    <h1>Hello World</h1>
    <p>Welcome to my website.</p>
  </body>
</html>
```

3. HTML Elements and Tags

An HTML **element** usually consists of an opening tag, content, and a closing tag. For example, ** Hello ** creates a paragraph. Some elements, such as **<img>**, do not require a closing tag.

4. Common HTML Elements

Element	Purpose
<h1> – <h6>	Headings
	Paragraphs
<a>	Links
<img>	Images
, ,	Lists
	Generic block/container
	Generic inline container
<form>	User input forms

5. Attributes

HTML elements can have **attributes** that provide additional information or configuration. Attributes are normally written inside the opening tag.

```
<a href="https://example.com">Visit Example</a>
<img src="image.jpg" alt="A sample image">
```

6. HTML, CSS, and JavaScript

Modern websites commonly use three technologies together: **HTML** provides structure, **CSS** controls presentation and visual styling, and **JavaScript** adds behavior and interactivity.

7. Best Practices

• Use semantic elements such as **<header>**, **<nav>**, **<main>**, **<section>**, and **<footer>** where appropriate.
• Use meaningful headings in a logical order.
• Add descriptive **alt** text to informative images.
• Keep HTML clean, properly nested, and readable.
• Validate your markup and consider accessibility.

8. Key Takeaway

HTML is the foundation of web development. Learning its elements, document structure, attributes, and semantic markup provides the foundation needed before moving deeper into CSS, JavaScript, and modern web frameworks.